



YOU ARE PLAYING

Rory Penhallow

Keeper of the Clock Tower

"Twenty years of stairs, oil and midnight bells."



FOR RORY PENHALLOW'S EYES ONLY

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

A flat cap, a scarf, a big ring of keys and a lantern.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Has kept Larkhaven Clock Tower clean, oiled and locked for twenty years. Rory looks after the tower's time clock, which stamps a card for anyone who climbs.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** your employer, and the only person who outranks you in the tower
- ◆ **Avery Vale:** climbs the tower with you every New Year's Eve
- ◆ **Dakota Fenwick:** tonight's fireworks master, setting up in the tower yard

PAGE 2

Before the game

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3

Rounds 1 · 2

Read each only when told

PAGE 4

Round 3 · Notes

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH

You are innocent. You did not harm Ellis. But you do have something to hide, so tonight you will look suspicious.

Your background

You have looked after the tower for twenty years. You know every step, every creak and every pigeon.

YOUR SECRET

You are terrified that the new keeper of Old Lark's keys will replace you. You have also been letting Dakota Fenwick store fireworks in the tower, which Ellis strictly forbade. Ellis found out this morning and was furious.

Your story tonight

From 9:30 to 10:30 you were in the tower yard helping Dakota Fenwick set out the midnight fireworks.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Keep your job, whoever holds the keys
- ◆ Keep the fireworks storage quiet
- ◆ Make sure Old Lark strikes midnight on time

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



✦ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ The tower time clock is set by Old Lark itself, and only your key can change it.
- ◆ Tonight only one card was stamped: whoever climbed is on it.
- ◆ You spent 9:30 to 10:30 in the tower yard with Dakota Fenwick.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** how Old Lark was running tonight.
- ◆ Ask **Parker Brightwell** whether your job is safe.

YOUR TASK

Tell at least two people how the tower punch card works.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

✦ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ If anyone mentions fireworks in the tower, admit it. You were only being helpful.
- ◆ Just before 10:00 you saw a light come on at the top of the tower: someone was oiling Old Lark.
- ◆ The yard is in plain sight of Dakota the whole time, and Dakota of you.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Dakota Fenwick** how many fireworks they actually have.
- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** whether they plan to keep the tower keeper.

YOUR TASK

Show the punch card (E7) to the group and explain the times.

Round 3 and notes



✦ Round 3✦ ✦ ✦

Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Admit your fear of being replaced. Fear is not the same as harm.
- ◆ Ellis kept the workshop shelf neat as a pin: every bottle and tin had its own spot.
- ◆ You have never seen Ellis miss the ten o'clock winding of the mantel clock.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** why the fireworks display looks so small this year.
- ◆ Ask **Emerson Quill** who walked past the corridor bench.

YOUR TASK

Ring an imaginary bell and lead a minute’s silence for Ellis before the ballots.

Notes

Suspects at a glance

- Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker
- Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City
- Harper Lune · The Clockmaker’s Long-Lost Relative
- Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer
- Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower
- Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master

- Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven
- Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger
- Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner
- Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader
- Blair Okafor · Town Historian
- Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer